Adrian Erlikhman

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Firstness – Software Engineering & ML Intern · [firstness.ai] · reporting directly to the founder 2026 - Present

- Refining how the platform connects into the research stack, and building demos that make it easier to understand.

Kiddom – Machine Learning Internship & Mentorship · K–12 EdTech 2026 - Present

- Designing ML and NLP approaches to teacher-facing problems in K–12 assessment with Kiddom's Director of Data Science; built **Why Wrong**, which names the misconception behind each wrong answer on a class's answer sheets (F1 0.87).

Fjor Venture Capital – Investment & Software Engineering Intern · $15M early-stage fund 2024 - 2026

- Built scoring models to screen 134 startups in Y Combinator's Summer 2025 batch and led the screen with Managing Director Tatiana Janko; ran diligence on 20+ AI startups and wrote 10+ investment memos.

Alliance for SoCal Innovation – Venture & Data Strategy Intern 2024 - 2026

- Built a Python/SQL investor-matching engine over 10K contacts at 250+ firms; deduplication cut founder-to-investor lookups from days to under a minute.

VENTURES & CIVIC TECHNOLOGY

AIML-LI (AI/ML Literacy Initiative) – Co-Founder & Lead · [aiml-initiative.org] 2023 - Present

- Co-wrote a free AI-literacy course, twelve 30-minute sessions any teacher can run on Chromebooks, taught in LACES AP Computer Science; LAUSD is taking it to its Chief Academic and Chief Information Officers toward a district elective.
- Organizing the LA Student AI Summit & Hackathon for 500+ public-school students: keynotes from Google DeepMind, Microsoft, Google and Snap, backed by Snap, Jane Street, MongoDB, Confluent and Discovery Education.
- **Invited speaker, NCSS 2026:** aiEDU's student panel on AI, National Consortium of STEM Schools, San Diego, Dec 2026.

SafeJew – Co-Founder · [safejew.org] · JFEDLA Teen Innovation Grant 2024 - Present

- Live map of 1,394 antisemitic incidents, 800 across Greater LA and 594 on 33 campuses, kept current by a scheduled GitHub Action and a hand-written LA gazetteer. Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase.

RESEARCH

Whose Line Is It Anyway? Auditing Self- and Other-Recognition in LLM Judges *Preprint, arXiv forthcoming*

- Co-first author, advised by Philo Juang (Google DeepMind). Nine LLM judges, 1,270 texts: the usual self-recognition test flags 15 of 37 cases, 3 beat a peer baseline and none beats its strongest single peer; an 18-feature stylometric classifier (86.3%) beats every judge.

Do LLM Fingerprints Survive Outside English? *Best Paper Finalist, IEEE BigData 2026 HS Symposium*

- Co-first author. 840 essays from five models in seven languages: attribution holds at 59–72% against 20% chance, with no detected drop for low-resource languages, and survives Google Translate. [abstract] [poster] [code]

Curated to Win: Certifying Reward-Model and Judge Selection Against Evaluation-Set Curation *Accepted, ARRSI Workshop @ AACL-IJCNLP 2026*

- Sole author. A certificate for how much of a validation set can be removed before the chosen reward model or LLM judge changes: on RewardBench, 12 of 2,985 items. [pdf] [code]

How Robust Are the Legatum Prosperity Index Rankings? *Accepted with revisions, Journal of High School Science*

- Co-first author, with Ryan Erlikhman. Derived rank leverage, $c^2(1-\rho^2)$, which tracks Sobol' total effects (Spearman 0.91–0.99); the ranking holds globally but not mid-table, where the median 90% rank interval spans 36 places. [pdf]

COMPETITIONS

- **Y Combinator Startup School**, sub-5%, $30,000+ in credits [about] · **Finalist (top 8), Citadel High School Terminal** [about]
- **1st place, VISION HACK: South LA** (Council District 9 Champion, U18). Ledger: led the build across the vision pipeline, rule engine and frontend, and wrote the two-pass vision pipeline, the dashboard and renewal calendar, and the static fallback. [live]
- **1st place, Decode the Ocean Hackathon** (Lovable × UN). eDNAtlas: live coastal health scores from environmental DNA. [live]
- **3rd place internationally, Code for Transportation** (Young Coders' Sphere). Safe Routes to School: A* over 431,599 crime-scored LA blocks, entirely in the browser; the bus cuts a student's modeled exposure by up to 80%. [live]

EDUCATION

Los Angeles Center for Enriched Studies (LACES) – Class of 2027 · LAUSD magnet school Los Angeles, CA

- GPA 5.2 weighted, 4.0 unweighted · SAT 1520 · 2× AP Scholar with Distinction · 17 APs
- Dual enrollment: Linear Algebra (MATH 270) · Programming in Python (CS 119) · Python for Data Science and ML (CS 121, planned)

LEADERSHIP & ATHLETICS

- **Épée fencing:** USA Fencing A26; Team USA, 2026 Cadet Pan American Championships (6th); U.S. No. 49 Junior and No. 78 Senior, peak No. 17 Cadet; 3× All-American First Team; in active recruitment with MIT.
- **President**, Jewish Student Union (50+ members) · **Co-Founder & President**, STEMsters (30+ volunteers in 4 elementary schools)

SKILLS

- Python, TypeScript/JavaScript, SQL, LaTeX · PyTorch, scikit-learn, TensorFlow, pandas, NumPy · Next.js, React, Supabase · LLM evaluation, stylometry, Monte Carlo and Sobol' sensitivity analysis · English, Russian (fluent), Spanish